

A1

GRAMMAR LESSON · MODAL VERBS

Ability: Can / Could / Be able to

Talking about ability now, in the past and in the future.

Yetenek Belirten Modaller

QUICK UNDERSTANDING

Can, could ve **be able to**, birinin bir şeyi **yapabildiğini/yapabileceğini** (yeteneğini) anlatmak için kullanılır. Can şimdiki zamanda, could geçmişte genel bir yetenek için kullanılır; be able to ise her zamanda kullanılabilen, can/could'un yerini tutan geniş bir yapıdır. Belirli, tek seferlik bir başarıdan bahsederken "managed to" veya "succeeded in" tercih edilir.

The Structure

Formula

Subject + can/could + V1

Subject + am/is/are/was/were/will be/have been + able to + V1

Subject + managed to + V1 / succeeded in + V-ing

can ve could'dan sonra "to" GELMEZ; be able to'dan sonra "to" mutlaka vardır.

Affirmative / Negative / Question

AFFIRMATIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION
I can swim.	I can't/cannot swim.	Can you drive?
She was able to fix it.	He couldn't come yesterday.	Could you swim as a child?
They managed to escape.	We weren't able to reach him.	Were you able to fix the car?

Word Order

Özne — can/could/be able to — fiil (V1)

- She **can** play the piano. — Piyano çalabiliyor.
- I **wasn't able to** finish the race. — Yarışı bitiremedim.

How It Works

When do we use it?

- **can**: şimdiki zamanda genel yetenek — I can speak French.
- **could**: geçmişte genel/süregelen bir yetenek — When I was a child, I could climb trees easily.
- **be able to (tüm zamanlarda)**: can/could'un can'ın eksik olduğu zamanlarda (gelecek, present perfect, infinitive) yerini alır — I will be able to drive next year. / I have never been able to understand him.
- **managed to / succeeded in**: zor bir durumda TEK SEFERLİK bir başarı — After three attempts, she managed to pass the driving test.

When DON'T we use it?

Belirli, tek seferlik bir başarı için "could" KULLANMA — could sadece genel/süregelen bir yeteneği anlatır.

✗ The exam was very hard, but I could pass it. → ✓ The exam was very hard, but I managed to pass it. / I was able to pass it.

İki modalı yan yana KULLANMA: ✗ I will can speak English fluently. → ✓ I will be able to speak English fluently.

Short Answers

Kısa cevap kullanılan modalla verilir: Yes, I can. / No, I can't. — Yes, I could. / No, I couldn't. — Yes, I was. / No, I wasn't.

Not: "managed to" ile kısa cevap normal fiil gibi verilir: Yes, I did. / No, I didn't.

Türkçe Mantığı

Zihninde şu sırayla ilerle:

TÜRKÇEDE NE DEMEK İSTİYORUM? → "Yüzebiliyorum." / "Çocukken yüzebilirdim." / "Dün maçı kazanmayı başardık." → NE ZAMAN? → Şimdi mi (can), geçmişte genel bir yetenek mi (could), yoksa belirli bir olayda tek seferlik bir başarı mı (managed to)? → HANGİ YAPI? → can (şimdi) / could (genel geçmiş) / managed to, was able to (tek seferlik başarı) → CÜMLE → "I can swim." / "I could swim when I was five." / "We managed to win the match."

Examples

CAN — ŞİMDİKİ YETENEK

- My little brother can already read. — Küçük kardeşim artık okuyabiliyor.
- Can you ride a bicycle? — Bisiklet sürebiliyor musun?
- I can't lift this box, it's too heavy. — Bu kutuyu kaldıramıyorum, çok ağır.

COULD — GEÇMİŞTE GENEL YETENEK

- My grandfather could speak four languages. — Dedem dört dil konuşabilirdi.
- When I was ten, I could run very fast. — On yaşındayken çok hızlı koşabilirdim.
- She couldn't cook at all before she moved abroad. — Yurt dışına taşınmadan önce hiç yemek pişiremezdi.

BE ABLE TO / MANAGED TO — DİĞER ZAMANLAR VE TEK SEFERLİK BAŞARI

- I haven't been able to sleep well this week. — Bu hafta iyi uyuyamadım.
- Will you be able to attend the meeting on Friday? — Cuma günkü toplantıya katılabilecek misin?
- After a long negotiation, we managed to get a better price. — Uzun bir pazarlıktan sonra daha iyi bir fiyat almayı başardık.
- Despite the traffic, she was able to arrive on time. — Trafiğe rağmen zamanında varabildi.
- He finally succeeded in convincing his parents. — Sonunda ailesini ikna etmeyi başardı.
- The firefighters managed to put out the fire quickly. — İtfaiyeciler yangını hızlıca söndürmeyi başardı.

Compare & Notice

Compare With

Ability (Bu Konu) Bir şeyi yapma YETENEĞİNİ/becerisini anlatır — fiziksel veya zihinsel bir kapasite. I can swim across the lake.	Permission (İzin) Aynı "can/could" kelimeleri, birinden İZİN istemek veya izin vermek için de kullanılır — anlam bağlama göre değişir. Can I swim in this lake? (İzin var mı?)
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→ İzin ve rica belirten modallere git

Karar Şeması (Decision Guide)

Soru: Genel/süregelen bir yetenektan mi, yoksa belirli tek bir olayda başarıdan mı bahsediyorsun?

GENEL YETENEK (ŞİMDİ) can + V1 → "I can drive."	GENEL YETENEK (GEÇMİŞ) could + V1 → "I could drive when I was 18."	TEK SEFERLİK, ZOR BİR BAŞARI managed to / was able to + V1 → "I managed to park in that tiny space."
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Common Mistakes

✗ The race was hard, but I could finish it.	✓ The race was hard, but I managed to finish it. / I was able to finish it.
WHY? could yalnızca genel/süregelen bir yeteneği anlatır; tek seferlik, zor bir durumdaki başarı için managed to veya was able to kullanılır.	
✗ I will can help you tomorrow.	✓ I will be able to help you tomorrow.
WHY? İki modal fiil yan yana kullanılamaz; can'in gelecek hali "will be able to"dur.	
✗ She can to speak Italian.	✓ She can speak Italian.
WHY? can'den sonra "to" gelmez, doğrudan V1 gelir — "to" sadece "be able to" yapısında vardır.	
✗ They succeeded to fix the engine.	✓ They succeeded in fixing the engine.
WHY? "succeed in" edatından sonra fiile -ing eklenir (V-ing), "to + V1" değil — managed to ile karıştırılır.	
✗ I no can understand this lesson.	✓ I can't understand this lesson.
WHY? can'in olumsuzu "cannot/can't" şeklinde tek kelime/bitişik yapılır, "no can" Türkçeden birebir çeviridir ve İngilizcede yoktur.	

Practice

Name: _____

Date: _____

Score: _____ / 16

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. She can _____ Italian.
a) speaking b) speak c) to speak d) speaks
2. I will _____ help you tomorrow.
a) could b) be able to c) able to d) can
3. When I was a child, I _____ climb trees easily.
a) will be able to b) am able to c) can d) could

PART B · PRACTICE

4. I _____ understand this lesson. It's too difficult. (not / can)

5. Find the mistake and correct it.

They ^A succeeded to fix ^B the engine. ^C

Correction: _____

6. The race was very hard, but in the end you finished it.

Which sentence is best?

- a) I can finish the race.
b) I could finish the race.
c) I managed to finish the race.
d) I will be able to finish the race.

7. _____ you swim?

- a) Are b) Do c) Can d) Does

8. Rewrite with "be able to": "She can't come tomorrow."

She _____ come tomorrow.

PART C · FINAL CHECK

9. My grandmother _____ read without glasses.
a) can to b) doesn't can c) isn't can d) can't
10. I have never _____ understand him.
a) been able to b) could c) be able d) can
11. Find the mistake and correct it.
I ^A no can ^B swim. ^C
Correction: _____
12. _____ you ride a bike when you were five? (could)
13. After three attempts, he _____ pass the driving test.
a) managed to b) can c) could d) can't

14. "I could run fast when I was young." What does it mean?

- a) I ran fast only once.
- b) I will run fast.
- c) I am a fast runner now.
- d) I was a fast runner in the past.

15. A friend asks: "Can you play the piano?" You can't.

What do you say?

- a) No, I not can.
- b) No, I don't.
- c) No, I can.
- d) No, I can't.

16. Rewrite with "able": "Can you come to the party?"

Are you _____ come to the party?

Answer Key

Kısa açıklamalar, her cevabın hangi kurala dayandığını gösterir.

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. **b) speak** — Can'den sonra fiil yalın hâldedir; to gelmez.
2. **b) be able to** — Gelecekte yetenek: will be able to (will can ✗).
3. **d) could** — Geçmişteki genel yetenek: could.

PART B · PRACTICE

4. **can't / cannot / can not** — Olumsuz: can't + V1.
5. **B — succeeded to fix → succeeded in fixing** — succeed in + V-ing: They succeeded in fixing the engine.
6. **c) I managed to finish the race.** — Zor durumda tek seferlik başarı: managed to (ya da was able to).
7. **c) Can** — Yetenek sorusu: Can you swim?
8. **She won't be able to come tomorrow.** — Gelecek olumsuz: won't be able to.

PART C · FINAL CHECK

9. **d) can't** — Olumsuz: can't + V1.
10. **a) been able to** — Present perfect'te can kullanılamaz: have been able to.
11. **B — no can → can't** — Olumsuz: I can't swim.
12. **Could** — Geçmişte yetenek sorusu: Could you...?
13. **a) managed to** — Zor ve tek seferlik başarı → managed to.
14. **d) I was a fast runner in the past.** — could = geçmişteki genel yetenek.
15. **d) No, I can't.** — Can sorusuna kısa cevap: No, I can't.
16. **Are you able to come to the party?** — can = be able to: Are you able to come?

Bu dersin interaktif versiyonu (anında geri bildirimli alıştırma):

<https://abonlinenglish.school/grammar/a1/ability-can-could-be-able-to>